

UCLA ANDERSON

INSIDER TIPS



ABOUT ANDERSON

UCLA Anderson defines its community by three core qualities: share success, think fearlessly, and drive change. It's lauded for pioneering the nation's first field-study program nearly 50 years ago – the Applied Management Research Program – and establishing the Easton Technology Management Center. Anderson's motto, "Think in the Next," speaks to a penchant for bold thinkers who are unafraid to chart new pathways and effect change.

The incoming class of 360 MBA candidates is nested within a powerhouse university of more than 40,000 students, located in one of the most diverse cities in the US. As the world's 15th largest economy, Los Angeles is home to more than 300,000 small businesses, and its vibrant tech scene produces four times the GDP of Silicon Valley. Its reputation as a creative city in media and entertainment are unparalleled, but LA's strengths extend to sectors such as consulting, finance, health care and consumer products. This nexus of industry, creativity and business-creation offers noteworthy access to company visits, guest speakers, mentors and internships.

Anderson has a nine-course core curriculum includes the option to add a specialization for a deeper dive into a target industry or function. The second year of study is entirely by individual design, allowing students to choose from an array of electives. Students also complete an Applied Management Research project (AMR), a two-quarter capstone experience that synthesizes classroom learning and applies it in a real-world business setting.

STRENGTHS & SPECIALIZATIONS

Entrepreneurship, finance, tech, communications and
entertainment

KEY STATS

MBA RANKINGS*	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021
BusinessWeek	19	18	12	12	*
Financial Times	32	25	26	25	*
Forbes	15	-	16	-	-
The Economist	6	8	6	-	*
US News	15	16	16	16	18

CLASS OF 2022 ADMISSIONS

Number of Applicants	2866	Avg Age	28
MBA Class Size	360	Avg GMAT	706
Admissions selectivity	34.40%	Avg GPA	3.45
Yield	36.51%	% International	36%
Total Tuition	US\$130,248	% Women	40%

POST-MBA CAREERS (CLASS OF 2019)

Technology	30.7%
Consulting	21.3%
Finance	16.1%
Consumer Products	9.1%

TOP RECRUITERS INCLUDE:

Adobe, Amazon, Deloitte, Bain & Company, Cisco, Citi, Credit Suisse, Epson, Bank of America Merrill Lynch, Microsoft, Google, Genentech, Comcast NBC Universal, Amgen ,EY, Mattel, AT&T, McKinsey, Sony, Nike, Rothschild & Co. , Zs, PwC, BCG, Walt Disney Company

AVERAGE BASE SALARY: **US\$129,602**

EMPLOYED IN 3 MONTHS: **89.9%**



TOP TIPS FOR ACING YOUR UCLA ANDERSON APPLICATION

BY JESSICA CHUNG

Jessica joined Fortuna after a decade of experience with UCLA Anderson. Serving as Associate Director of Admissions, she evaluated and interviewed thousands of applications for the full-time MBA program. She also managed the program's global recruiting and admit events, advised on fellowship decisions for admitted students and collaborated on strategic projects.



Through the application and interview, the admissions team scours the pool for individuals who are highly collaborative, with a sense of humbleness and openness to feedback.

1

KNOW ANDERSON'S PRINCIPLES

A few years back, the school defined its driving principles - Share Success, Think Fearlessly, Drive Change - which adcoms use as a filter for assessing each candidate. The website has some good examples with specific student, alumni and faculty stories illuminating these principles in action. This year's singular essay question challenges you to reflect deeply on how the events of the past year influenced the impact you would like to make in your community, career, or both. There is a lot of opportunity to exemplify one or more of those qualities as you consider your response.

GET TO KNOW THE COMMUNITY

2

Adcoms expect candidates to go beyond surface level research when getting to know Anderson and the community. While you can typically meet school reps at events throughout the year (most events now moved to a virtual format in light of the pandemic), making an effort to forge deeper connections with students and alumni - especially those with similar backgrounds/goals - using their stories to support your candidacy is especially compelling. If you can't attend an in-person event, emailing officers of student clubs is another great way to learn more about careers/recruiting. Take advantage of these pathways to build relationships with students and learn their stories. Covid conditions permitting, we highly recommend a visit to campus.

3

UNDERSTAND THE CULTURE

Piggybacking on the previous point, strong cultural fit is an extremely important aspect of the evaluation process. Anderson prides itself on being very supportive and looks for individuals who are driven but not cutthroat competitive. Through the application and interview, the admissions team scours the pool for individuals with these qualities - being highly collaborative but with a sense of humbleness and openness to feedback. There's a strong entrepreneurial spirit in the program as well, so showing this mindset (not necessarily being an entrepreneur, but demonstrating innovative thinking within your company) is crucial.

INVOLVEMENT IS CRUCIAL

4

Anderson has a rich tradition of active involvement outside the classroom, and the school highly encourages creating new clubs or events as needs of the student community evolves. Most activities on campus are student driven or led, and it's a big priority to craft a class that will uphold this legacy each year. History of involvement in extracurriculars, volunteer work, etc., is important beyond a superficial level, so you should demonstrate true passion and dedication to the causes and communities to which you belong. If you don't have a robust extracurricular profile and want to beef it up in the time before submitting applications, I suggest looking for roles that go beyond being a mere "member" and make a substantive contribution - organize an event, revamp an organization's social media strategy, analyze ROI on events and suggest improvements, etc.

5

EMPHASIZE LOCATION

Candidates should be familiar with LA/SoCal/CA's vibrant business culture, diversity, and pioneering spirit, and connect it back to their goals and/or "why Anderson." What really frustrates adcoms are applicants who apply with a very stereotyped mindset about Anderson - e.g. it's only for anyone interested in entertainment, there aren't many opportunities in finance/consulting, it's a "regional" school and you can't get a job outside of CA, etc. Understanding the benefits of the school's strategic LA location, and not falling (even unconsciously) into stereotypes or biases (such as "LA is more laid back than east coast cities") will signal that you're a serious candidate. Be familiar with LA's strengths - e.g., virtually every major company is headquartered or has an office in Southern CA, LA is the world's 16th largest economy, and Silicon Beach is a major tech hub bringing in billions in VC funding each year.

For more insider insights into UCLA Anderson
please visit the [Fortuna Blog](#).

DEADLINES & DATES

	APPLICATION DEADLINE	DECISION NOTIFICATION
1st Deadline	05 October 2021	14 December 2021
2nd Deadline	04 January 2022	22 March 2022
3rd Deadline	12 April 2022	17 May 2022



**The best time to
apply is when you're
ready.**

Caroline Diarte Edwards,
Co-Founder & Director of Fortuna Admissions

LET'S GET YOU IN.

Fortuna Admissions is a dream team of former MBA Admissions Directors and Officers from the top-tier business schools, including Wharton, INSEAD, Harvard Business School, Stanford GSB, Kellogg, LBS, Chicago Booth, Columbia, NYU Stern, IE, Duke Fuqua, UCLA Anderson, Yale SOM, Cornell Johnson and Berkeley Haas.

As industry experts, we regularly provide commentary and analysis about b-school admissions for major media around the world. To read our full range of advice visit: FortunaAdmissions.com

With our unparalleled collective expertise, we are able to coach you to develop a clear vision of your goals for business school and beyond. We work closely with you throughout the application process and provide expert guidance at every stage to maximize your chances of admission to a top school.

Our free consultations are consistently rated as the best in the industry. To learn more about Fortuna and assess your chances of admission, reserve yours at: FortunaAdmissions.com

